



» FIH PRO LEAGUE

Mark of a leader: Indian captain Harmanpreet Singh celebrates along with his teammates during an FIH Pro League match against England. BISWARANJAN ROUT

Coaches take stock as India betters its FIH Pro League show from previous season

With both the men and women finishing in the bottom half of the table in the previous edition of the Pro League, the current season has **a lot riding on it**, a spot at the 2026 World Cup being just one of them.

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The recent FIH Pro League marked the beginning of Indian hockey's international assignments in 2025. Coming just a fortnight after the revived Hockey India League, the Bhubaneswar leg of the

competition was expected to be a testing ground for the year ahead, and the results, while encouraging, also highlighted areas that still need work for both the men and women.

With both the men and women finishing in the bottom half of the table in the previous edition, the women barely managing to hang on to their spot in the second-last

position, the current season has a lot riding on it for Indian hockey, a spot at the 2026 World Cup being just one of them. **It is also a chance for the men to continue building their core for the next four years leading up to LA28, and for the women to get back on the grind with a clean slate.**

While the men finished their quota of eight games with five wins to be